

Data Classification -- Guided Notes

Unit tp-5.1 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 5.1 | N10-008 FC0-U71 5.1

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Complete each question using the lesson reading. Write in the blank or answer in the space provided.

Question 1

Data classification is the process of organizing data into categories based on its _____ and the level of _____ required. Organizations classify data to apply _____ controls -- not all data needs the same protection, and over-protecting low-sensitivity data wastes resources.

Question 2

Common civilian data classification levels from lowest to highest sensitivity are: _____ (available to the public), _____ (internal use only, not for external distribution), _____ (limited to authorized staff), and _____ (highest risk if disclosed, limited to need-to-know individuals).

Question 3

PII (Personally Identifiable Information) is data that can identify a _____ individual. Examples include _____, _____, _____, and _____ (name at least four). Regulations like _____ (US healthcare) and _____ (EU privacy) require specific handling of PII.

Question 4

PHI (Protected Health Information) is a specific subset of PII relating to a person's _____ condition, treatment, or payment for care. It is protected by _____ in the United States. Organizations that handle PHI (hospitals, insurers, labs) are called _____ entities and must follow strict safeguards.

Question 5

The principle of _____ requires that individuals and systems only have access to the data they need for their specific job function -- no more. A marketing employee should not have access to _____ records. A help desk technician does not need access to the company's _____ source code repository.

Question 6

Data _____ marks files with their classification level so access control policies can be enforced automatically. _____ prevents sensitive data from leaving an organization via email, USB, or cloud upload by monitoring and blocking classified content. This technology is called _____ (Data Loss Prevention).

Question 7

Structured data is organized in a defined format that can be easily _____ (e.g., database tables, spreadsheets). Unstructured data has no predefined format -- examples include _____, _____, and _____. Semi-structured data has some organizational properties but does not fit a relational model -- _____ and XML are examples.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A hospital employee accidentally emails a spreadsheet containing 500 patients social security numbers and diagnoses to an external vendor. Identify the regulatory framework violated, classify the data by type (PII/PHI), and describe two technical controls that could have prevented this from happening.

Download the answer key from the class server:

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wget http://[SERVER]/resources/network-engineer/tp-5-1-data-classification/tp-5-1-data-classification-answer-key.pdf
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